ZOO506 CATERPILLARS &CUTWORMS
DISCUSSION BY SULMAN ALI

01: Caterpillars:

Kingdom: Animalia

Phylum: Arthropods

Class: Insecta

Order: Lepidoptera

Is Caterpillar insect or pest:

Adults Caterpillars are insects, just like their parent butterflies or moths. But larval stage of Adults Caterpillars (butterflies) are consider to be a pest.

In which crops the Caterpillar effects:

Leafy vegetables; brassica vegetables; greenhouse vegetables; beans; tomatoes; potatoes. Chew large ragged holes in leaves and bore into the heads of crops. May also feed on flowers and pods.

In which order the Caterpillars belongs?, Why Caterpillars belong to this order?

Order: Lepidoptera

Reason:

Lepidoptera comes from the Greek words lepido, which means scale and pteron, which means wing. Butterflies and moths have four wings covered with tiny scales.

Life cycle of Caterpillar.

Four (4) stages: the egg, the larva (caterpillar), the pupa (chrysalis or cocoon) and the adult.

In which stage of life cycle the Caterpillars considered as a pest?

larval stage:

The larval stage of Adults Caterpillars (butterflies) are consider to be a pest.

Biological control of Caterpillar in the crops:

Bacillus thuringiensis subspecies kurstaki (Btk) (Dipel DF) is a microbial insecticide that kills only caterpillars. It's safe to use near bees, beneficial insects, and wildlife.

Chemical method to control Caterpillar

We recommended Aerosol/ spraying method to do this.

Chemicals that kill the Caterpillar or other insects are pyre- thrins and synthetic pyrethroids

02: Cutworms

Kingdom: Animalia

Phylum: Arthropods

Class: Insecta

Order: Lepidoptera

Is Cutworms insect or pest:

Pest: Cutworms are plump, smooth caterpillars, of several moth species. They feed on all crop and pasture plants, damaging them near the ground.

In which crops the Cutworms effects:

Cutworms are general feeders that can attack a wide range of plants. Common vegetables they like to feed on include asparagus, beans, cabbage and other crucifers, carrots, celery, corn, lettuce, peas, peppers, potatoes and tomatoes. A few species feed on turfgrass.

In which order the Cutworms belongs?, Why Cutworms belong to this order?

Order: Lepidoptera

Reason:

Lepidoptera comes from the Greek words lepido, which means scale and pteron, which means wing. Butterflies and moths have four wings covered with tiny scales.

Life cycle of Cutworms.

Four (4) stages: the egg, the larva, the pupa, and the adult.

In which stage of life cycle the Cutworms considered as a pest?

larval stage:

The larval stage of various cutworm species (including redbacked, pale western, darksided and dingy), can cause damage to canola plants by feeding on the cotyledons, leaves, stems or under soil surfaces.

Biological control of Cutworms in the crops:

Natural enemies of cutworms include predaceous or parasitic insects, mammals, parasitic nematodes, pathogens, birds, and reptiles. The hymenopteran (wasp) parasites, including ichneumonids, chalcids, braconids, and sphecids, are the most important group of cutworm natural enemies.

Chemical method to control Cutworms

We recommended Aerosol/ spraying method to do this.

Synthetic pyrethroid insecticides such as deltamethrin, cyfluthrin, bifenthrin, permethrin and lambda-cyhalothrin will work very well to reduce damage from cutworms. Safe alternative products include Bt (Bacillus thuringiensis) and insect parasitic nematodes.